Glossary and Decision Log

UTeM Micro-Credential Management System (MCMS)

Document Control

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Disclaimer:

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Table of Contents

1. Introduction 5
1.1 Purpose 5
1.2 Document Conventions 5
1.3 Intended Audience 6
1.4 Scope of this Document 6
1.5 References 6
2. Key Concepts from the Guide 7
2.1 Micro-Credential Categories 7
2.2 The Separate Recognition Stages 7
2.3 Key Numeric Rules (Configurable) 8
3. Decision Log 9
3.1 Status Key 9
3.2 Decisions 9
3.3 Assumptions Register 14
3.4 Open Items for CODL / Supervisor Confirmation 14
4. Change Control 16
Appendix A: UCreds Content 17
A.1 The platform 17
A.2 What the catalogue contains 17
A.3 Programmes, subjects and subject codes 18
A.4 The public course directory 18
A.5 Course profiles 22
A.6 Learner support 22

Glossary

Term	Definition
ABC	Academic Bank of Credit. Central digital depository of ACR. A deposit is storage and does not approve transfer. [G 12.5]
ACR	Academic Credit Record. Academic record used in the ABC mechanism; prepared only for an eligible completed UMC or Quality-Verified SAMC. [G 12.4]
Achievement Record	UTeM internal record of modules passed, Digital Badges and MC completion (Rekod Pencapaian Pembelajaran). It is not an ACR. [G 8.7.5, 18.3]
Adapter	A defined interface to an external system (UCreds, ABC, QVC/MQA, payment, SSO, email) with a stub or manual version in the first release.
API	Application Programming Interface
Audit trail	Append-only record of approvals, credential actions, result changes and corrections. History is never erased. [G 10.5.1, 18.10]
CODL	Centre for Open and Distance Learning. System administrator and technical operator of MCMS and operator of UCreds. CODL takes no academic decision in MCMS (D-12).
Configurable value	A threshold or list kept in settings and never hard-coded (40 h SLT, 3-year QV limit, 10-year credit validity, 30% home credit, residency, alert days, retention).
CQI	Continuous Quality Improvement: finding, evidence, analysis, action, implementation and effectiveness check. [G 17]
Credit accumulation	Building a record of eligible credit over time. Separate from credit transfer. [G 12]
Credit transfer	Evaluation and acceptance of credit by the programme that receives it; in MCMS decided by the deputy dean of the faculty that owns the degree (D-28). Equivalence is judged on learning outcomes, not on credit or SLT alone. [G 13]
Credit validity	Credit in ABC is valid 10 years from deposit date. This differs from ACR retention (indefinite unless the owner or authority directs otherwise). [G 12.8]
Digital Badge	Proof of achievement of one module or unit. Not academic credit and not an ACR. [G 8.7.1, App E1]
Digital Credential / Certificate	Proof of completing the whole MC (Sijil / Digital Credential). Does not by itself give credit or transfer. [G 8.7.3, App E1]
Deputy dean (PTj)	The faculty deputy dean who owns micro-credential offerings in MCMS: endorses, verifies, confirms quality and records decisions (D-28).
HEPA	Student Affairs and Alumni Department. Assumed to register outside applicants together with Pejabat Pendaftar.
Material change	Change to outcomes, SLT, assessment, module structure, credit, MQF level, parent course link or QV status. Needs review and re-approval and is versioned. [G 9.5, 17.7, 17.8]
MCE	Micro-Credential Eksekutif. Non-credit short learning under 40 hours SLT. Never carries credit unless reclassified and re-approved as a SAMC. [G 6.3.3]
MQA / MQF	Malaysian Qualifications Agency / Malaysian Qualifications Framework.
Micro-Credential (MC)	Certification of a small, focused unit of learning with defined outcomes and assessment. Recognition follows achievement, not attendance. [G 6.1]
Module	A smaller unit of a UMC. Completion earns a Digital Badge, not credit and not whole-UMC completion. [G 8.7.1]

Term	Definition
PTj	Pusat Tanggungjawab: the faculty, school, institute or centre that owns an offering. [G 15.2.2]
QA / QV / QVC	Quality Assurance applies to every MC. Quality Verification is the SAMC-specific check run by the QVC under MQA rules. Approval to offer is a separate decision from QV. [G 7.6, 11.2]
Quality-Verified SAMC	A SAMC that has passed QV. QV is valid for at most 3 continuous years and needs one completed cohort before submission. [G 11.2.1, 11.2.2]
RBAC	Role-Based Access Control
SAMC	Stand-alone Micro-Credential. Own offering, at least 40 hours SLT. Credit and MQF level exist only after QV. [G 6.3.2]
SDD	Software Design Description
Single Redemption	Credit used for one qualification cannot be used for another. Transfer makes credit provisionally redeemed; completing the programme makes it redeemed. [G 12.9]
SLT	Student Learning Time: all learning and assessment time, not only contact time. [G 8.3]
Stackable Degree	Planned pathway where eligible credit counts toward part of a degree. Needs admission, transfer approval, at least 30% credit earned at UTeM, residency (1 semester for conventional programmes), PLO mapping and graduation requirements. [G 14]
SRS / PRD	Software Requirements Specification / Product Requirements Document
SSO	Single Sign-On
UCreds	UTeM online learning platform for micro-credentials (ucreds.utem.edu.my), operated by CODL on Moodle; the pilot learning platform. Reached only through an adapter. Its public content is recorded in Appendix A (D-34).
UMC	Unbundled Micro-Credential. Made by unbundling an accredited credit course; keeps its parent link; total SLT equals the parent course; whole UMC is at least 40 hours SLT or one credit. [G 6.3.1]

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

This document fixes the vocabulary and the key decisions that the three controlling documents of the UTeM Micro-Credential Management System (MCMS), namely the Software Requirements Specification (SRS), the Product Requirements Document (PRD) and the Software Design Description (SDD), shall follow. Every later document shall use the terms in the Glossary with exactly these meanings and shall not contradict a decision in Section 3 unless the decision is first changed here and the version of this document is raised.

The document set is written for two readers at once: a supervisor who reviews it, and AI development agents and developers who use it as the guide, reference and rule set for building the system. For that reason requirements are written as single, identified statements with traceability to the Guide.

1.2 Document Conventions

This document and the document set follow these conventions:

Term	Description
SHALL	Mandatory requirement that must be fulfilled in Release 1, the first buildable release (prototype scope, decision D-22). The developer is required to cover this feature in Release 1.
SHOULD	Requirement planned for Release 2. The developer should take it into account in the design so that it can be added without rework.
MAY	Requirement anticipated for Release 3 or later. The developer is encouraged to keep it in mind for future scalability.
TBD	To Be Determined. Information not yet available that will be provided in a later version. Every TBD is linked to an open item (OI-xx).
Note	Provides additional information or clarification.

> **Note:** A requirement tagged with a Guide source, for example [G 12.9], states a rule that is mandatory for the complete system under UTeM policy. Its SHALL / SHOULD / MAY wording states only the release in which MCMS implements it. Guide rules are never relaxed by the release plan.

Requirements and records are categorised as follows:

Requirement Number	Description
FR-XX	Functional Requirements
NFR-XX	Non-Functional Requirements
IR-XX	Interface Requirements
DR-XX	Data Requirements
SR-XX	Security Requirements
BR-XX	Business Rules taken from the Guide (added to the reference categories, decision D-25)
D-XX / A-XX / OI-XX	Decision / Assumption / Open item (this document)

Source tags follow the Guide: [G 12.9] means Guide clause 12.9 and [App E5] means Guide appendix E, table E5.

1.3 Intended Audience

This document is intended for the following stakeholders:

Stakeholder	Role
Supervisor	Reviews the document set and the decisions taken.
CODL / UTeM reviewers	Confirm assumptions and open items; system owner (assumed).
Development team and AI development agents	Design and implement the system using these terms and decisions as fixed rules.
Testers and quality assurance	Derive acceptance tests from requirement IDs and rules.
System administrators	Maintain and configure the system after delivery.

1.4 Scope of this Document

In Scope

- Glossary of terms used across the SRS, PRD and SDD
- Key concepts of the Guide that drive the design (categories, recognition stages, numeric rules)
- Decision log, assumptions register and open items with the working assumption for each
- Change control for this document

Out of Scope

- Requirements, user needs and design detail, which belong to the SRS, PRD and SDD
- A Test Plan (acceptance tests are traced from SRS requirement IDs; decision D-01)
- Any change to the Guide itself

1.5 References

1. Garis Panduan Micro-Credential UTeM (the Guide), CODL UTeM, with Lampiran A to H: the copy held in the project (MC UTeM Guide.pdf), cover Versi 1.0, 18 September 2026 (D-03).
2. Software Requirements Specification, UTeM Micro-Credential Management System, informal draft v0.1, 23 October 2026 (input material only).
3. Software Requirements Specification for an AI-Driven Job Matching Platform, v1.0, May 2025. Used as a format reference only; no content is reused.
4. MQA: Guidelines to Good Practices on Micro-Credentials; Quality Verification of Stand-alone Micro-Credentials; Guidelines on the Academic Bank of Credit; Malaysian Qualifications Framework (second edition).
5. Guidelines on Developing Academic Programme through Stackable Degree Pathway.
6. ISO/IEC/IEEE 29148, Requirements engineering.
7. Open Badges 3.0 and W3C Verifiable Credentials data model (guidance for credential format).
8. WCAG 2.1; OWASP Application Security Verification Standard; Personal Data Protection Act 2010 (Act 709) with current amendments.
9. Software Requirements Specification, UTeM Micro-Credential Management System, v1.0 draft, 23 October 2026 (MCMS_SRS_V1.0_Oct_2026), written against v0.2 of this document; source of open items OI-09 to OI-15.
10. UCreds Public Portal Audit and Complete Course Directory, v1.0, 27 October 2026 (UCREDS_AUDIT_V1.0_Oct_2026; folder `UCreds` of the project): the source of Appendix A (D-34).
11. Software Requirements Specification v1.2 and Software Design Description v1.2, 28 October 2026, and the Release 1 review of 28 October 2026 (Release1_Review_2026-10-28): the build findings behind D-35 to D-37.

2. Key Concepts from the Guide

This section summarises the parts of the Guide that shape every design decision. It does not replace the Guide.

2.1 Micro-Credential Categories

Criterion	UMC	SAMC	MCE
Origin	Unbundled from an accredited credit course; keeps parent link	Own offering, not part of an accredited programme	Own non-credit short learning
SLT	Total equals parent course; whole UMC at least 40 h or 1 credit	At least 40 h	Under 40 h
Credit	Possible, subject to academic rules; only the whole UMC carries credit	Only after QV	None
Quality route	Quality assurance of parent programme	QA, plus QV if credit is sought	Internal UTeM QA
ABC deposit	Yes, if eligible	Only if Quality-Verified	No
Stackable degree	Yes, subject to conditions	Only if Quality-Verified	No

Source: Guide Table 1 and clauses 6.3 to 6.5.

2.2 The Separate Recognition Stages

The Guide treats each stage below as a different thing with its own decision and its own record [G 12 to 14, 18.14]. MCMS shall store them as separate records so that none can be skipped or mistaken for another.

Stage	Decided by	Does NOT imply
1. Approval to offer	Senate, after deputy dean endorsement; recorded by the deputy dean	Credit, QV, transfer
2. Module achievement (Digital Badge)	Lecturer assesses; deputy dean verifies; system issues the badge	Whole-MC completion, credit
3. MC completion (Certificate / Digital Credential)	Deputy dean confirms; system issues the credential	Credit, ACR, transfer
4. Quality Verification (SAMC only)	QVC / MQA	Transfer or admission
5. ACR and ABC deposit	System generates the ACR; participant consents; deputy dean records the deposit	Transfer approval
6. Credit transfer	Deputy dean of the faculty that owns the degree	Admission, degree award
7. Stackable degree award	UTeM academic programme	Nothing further

2.3 Key Numeric Rules (Configurable)

ID	Rule	Default	Source
BR-01	Minimum SLT for SAMC and for a whole UMC	40 hours (or 1 credit for UMC)	G 6.3.1, 6.3.2
BR-02	Maximum validity of Quality Verification	3 continuous years	G 11.2.2
BR-03	QV submission needs at least one completed cohort	1 cohort	G 11.2.1
BR-04	Validity of credit in ABC from deposit date	10 years	G 12.8
BR-05	Minimum credit earned at UTeM for a stackable degree	30% of graduating credit	G 14.5.1
BR-06	Residency for conventional programmes via stackable pathway	1 semester	G 14.5.3

3. Decision Log

3.1 Status Key

Decided: stated by the project owner or fixed by the Guide. **Assumed**: no answer yet; a working assumption is used and its effect if wrong is recorded in 3.3. **Proposed**: a recommendation awaiting confirmation. Every Assumed or Proposed item shall be built so that it can change through configuration or by replacing one adapter, not by rewriting modules.

3.2 Decisions

ID	Decision	Rationale / effect if changed	Status
D-01	The controlling document set is the SRS, the PRD and the SDD. A Test Plan is not in this set; acceptance tests are traced from SRS requirement IDs.	Matches the project owner's choice. A Test Plan can be added later without changing the three documents. Extended in v0.6 by D-30 (UI/UX Design Specification and System Flow Map).	Decided
D-02	All documents are written in English. The system (screens, notifications, credentials) shall support Bahasa Melayu and English.	Documents are read by a supervisor and by AI agents. Bilingual wording of the Guide is preserved through the Glossary.	Decided
D-03	The controlling Guide is the copy held in the project (MC UTeM Guide.pdf), whose cover says Versi 1.0, 18 September 2026. A "Version 2.0 Final, 15 September 2026" was named only in the informal draft SRS v0.1; no such copy is held in the project.	It is the only copy available. If a later version is issued, only the source tags need re-checking.	Decided (v0.4, closes OI-01)
D-04	A new, formal SRS shall be written. Its layout follows the reference SRS (document control, contents, glossary, numbered sections, identified requirement tables) with Guide terminology. The informal draft SRS v0.1 is input material only.	The draft ends at section 2.8 and its later sections do not exist. A new SRS avoids inheriting the gaps.	Decided
D-05	All documents are formal and professional in style and written so an AI agent can follow them without guessing: stable IDs, one requirement per statement, traceability to Guide clauses, explicit assumptions.	Dual audience: supervisor review and AI-assisted development.	Decided
D-06	MCMS is a new standalone system with its own database, login handling and workflow. It talks to other systems only through adapters.	Carried from draft SRS (C1, C3). Keeps UCreds and the student system untouched.	Decided
D-07	Architecture is a modular monolith: one deployable application with clearly separated modules (starting from the draft's M1 to M16, regrouped in the SDD if needed).	Simplest to build, test and host for a small team. Modules use internal interfaces, so later splitting stays possible.	Proposed
D-08	Primary technology is Laravel (PHP).	CODL mostly uses PHP, so maintenance stays with a familiar stack. Chosen by the project owner.	Decided
D-09	Database recommendation: PostgreSQL as the primary choice; MySQL or MariaDB is an acceptable fallback if CODL already hosts and supports it.	PostgreSQL gives strong constraints, transactional integrity, JSON fields for credential metadata and good support for append-only audit design. The SDD keeps queries portable through Laravel's database layer.	Proposed (OI-02)

ID	Decision	Rationale / effect if changed	Status
D-10	Identity: staff and participants sign in with their Microsoft education account through single sign-on (OpenID Connect assumed). Outside applicants register first at Pejabat Pendaftar or HEPA and then receive that account. MCMS offers no open public sign-up.	Stated by the project owner with details uncertain. If the method differs, only the SSO adapter and applicant recognition change.	Assumed (A-06, OI-03)
D-11	Approvals: the deputy dean (PTj) endorses proposals and the Senate gives final approval to offer, approves material changes and approves stackable degree mappings. The Senate does not use MCMS; the deputy dean records each Senate decision with its meeting reference. Individual credit transfer cases are decided by the deputy dean of the faculty that owns the degree. Approving roles stay settings, not code.	Confirmed by the project owner in v0.5. The Guide names no committees (App H), so routing remains configurable.	Decided (v0.5, closes OI-06)
D-12	CODL is the system administrator (S1) and technical operator (P5) of MCMS and the product owner. CODL takes no academic decision and holds no academic records role: it does not issue, correct or revoke credentials, prepare ACR or deposit credit.	Confirmed by the project owner in v0.5. Separates operation of the system from academic authority [G 15.2.3].	Decided (v0.5)
D-13	UCreds is the pilot learning platform. Its connection method is a placeholder for the next iteration; CSV import is the fallback. UCreds issues module badges and keeps its own database (confirmed by the audit of 27 October 2026, D-34); MCMS imports and checks badge data and issues certificates and Digital Credentials.	If UCreds should not issue badges, MCMS issues them instead (one adapter and one module change).	Assumed (A-04, OI-04); A-05 supported by the audit
D-14	QVC/MQA submission and payment are manual or stubbed in Release 1: MCMS prepares and tracks; UTeM staff submit. A dummy payment service stands in. The ABC deposit step stays in the flow after the ACR: the deputy dean records each deposit in MCMS. A national ABC platform is still a concept, so no live connection is built; it is added later by swapping one adapter if it becomes available.	External services are not ready or not integrable now. Each is replaced later by swapping one adapter.	Assumed (A-02, A-03)
D-15	Recognition stages (Section 2.2) shall be stored as separate records with separate decisions. No single status or button may combine them.	The single most important rule in the Guide [G 12 to 14, 18.14]. Overrides any convenience shortcut in later documents.	Decided
D-16	Thresholds in Section 2.3 and other limits shall be configurable settings, including alert days and retention periods.	Rules in the Guide may be revised by UTeM or MQA. Carried from draft SRS (C4).	Decided
D-17	Credit value, MQF level and QV wording shall be generated only from verified records, never typed by hand. A credential shall show credit, MQF or QV information only when verified and still valid.	Prevents false claims [G 10.5, App E5].	Decided

ID	Decision	Rationale / effect if changed	Status
D-18	The draft's rule C9 ("a UMC module is never a credit unit") is corrected: a UMC module is not a credit unit unless specifically approved as a separately recognisable credit unit. The whole UMC always carries the credit of its parent course. The approval is an academic decision taken case by case by the deputy dean (the approving role is a setting, D-11).	Guide 13.5 and 14.2.1 allow this exception. Guide 15.2.3 keeps academic decisions away from operational staff, so the System Administrator role does not approve it. The system shall support an approval flag whose default is no.	Decided (v0.5 names the deputy dean; closes OI-05)
D-19	Credentials use an open, signed format (Open Badges 3.0 and W3C Verifiable Credentials as guidance); blockchain is not required. Public verification needs no login and shows only the minimum permitted information.	Carried from draft SRS (C8). Privacy limits follow Guide App E6.	Proposed
D-20	All approvals, credential actions, result changes and corrections are written to an append-only audit log. Corrections never delete earlier records.	Required by G 10.5.1, 15.7 and 18.10. Also supports supervisor review.	Decided
D-21	Sizing figures (up to 200 offerings and 20,000 participants a year, peaks of 2,000 registering within hours) are indicative only and non-binding.	The project owner considers them a possibility, not fact. Design for modest scale without blocking growth.	Assumed (A-09)
D-22	The system is produced by an intern as a mock-up and concept. The documents describe the target system. Release 1 is the first buildable release (prototype scope); the PRD shall mark which features belong to Release 1, 2 and 3 or later.	Keeps the specification complete while being honest about prototype scope. Release numbers drive **SHALL** / **SHOULD** / **MAY** (D-24).	Decided
D-23	Deliverables are produced as PDF, one at a time, in this order: this document, SRS, PRD, SDD, and then the Release 1 prototype (D-31). The UI/UX Design Specification and System Flow Map were added in v0.6 (D-30). Work continues on the recorded assumptions without waiting for review between documents; supervisor review takes place once something tangible (the prototype) can be shown, and its comments are applied to all documents together.	Changed in v0.4 at the project owner's request: keeps the work moving while assumptions are explicit and changeable. Earlier wording required review before each next document.	Decided
D-24	**SHALL**, **SHOULD** and **MAY** indicate Release 1, Release 2 and Release 3 or later respectively, as in the reference SRS. Guide-mandated rules keep their [G] tag and stay binding on the full system regardless of release.	Follows the reference format while preventing the release plan from weakening any Guide rule. Replaces the plain shall / should / may meaning used in v0.1.	Proposed
D-25	A sixth requirement category, BR-XX (Business Rules from the Guide), is added to the reference categories FR, NFR, IR, DR and SR.	The Guide's rules are central to this system and need their own traceable IDs.	Proposed
D-26	Format of all documents follows the reference SRS: cover with Document Control table and disclaimer, table of contents, glossary, numbered sections with tinted headings, serif body text, and tables with ID and Requirement columns. The PRD and SDD adopt these elements where applicable and use their own section content.	Requested by the project owner. Only structure and layout are adopted; no content from the reference is reused.	Decided

ID	Decision	Rationale / effect if changed	Status
D-27	One credit equals 40 notional learning hours (SLT). The value is the default of a configurable setting and is used for UMC and SAMC credit calculations.	Confirmed by the project owner (closes OI-14); follows the MQF convention and the Guide's "40 hours or 1 credit" threshold [G 6.3.1].	Decided (v0.4)
D-28	MCMS has six kinds of user: Student (P8); Lecturer (P1), who creates and runs micro-credentials, assesses students, performs the quality review and collects QV evidence, and reviews colleagues' proposals when assigned (X1); Deputy dean of the PTj (P2), who endorses, records Senate decisions, confirms readiness, verifies results and completion, confirms quality review and QV evidence, corrects or revokes credentials, records ABC deposits, approves module credit, and (for the faculty owning a degree) decides credit transfers; Senate (P3), which approves but does not log in; CODL as system administrator and technical operator (S1, P5); and employers or the public, who verify credentials without login (X3). An industry expert (X2) may comment on proposals. The former separate roles quality unit (P4), records and credential unit (P6), ABC depositor (P7) and receiving programme evaluator (X4) are not used; their tasks move to the deputy dean or the system.	Confirmed by the project owner in v0.5. Fewer roles match how UTeM faculties actually work and keep CODL out of academic decisions.	Decided (v0.5)
D-29	Badges, certificates and Digital Credentials are issued automatically by the system when the deputy dean verifies results or confirms completion and the pre-issuance checks pass. ACR is generated automatically for eligible learning and confirmed by the deputy dean. Corrections, replacements and revocations are made by the deputy dean, with history kept.	Confirmed by the project owner in v0.5. Removes manual certificate preparation and keeps every academic decision with an academic role.	Decided (v0.5)
D-30	The document set is the SRS, the PRD, the UI/UX Design Specification (approved design basis, v1.1), the SDD and the System Flow Map (a navigable overview of roles, modules, events, jobs and data, derived from the SDD). The Glossary and Decision Log governs all of them. Where the UI/UX Design Specification and the SDD differ on a screen, flow or document ID, the UI/UX Design Specification controls; where they differ on structure or behaviour behind the screen, the SDD controls.	The SDD and the UI/UX Design Specification already treat each other as part of the set, while v0.5 listed only three documents.	Proposed (v0.6)
D-31	Two things are called a prototype. The design prototype is the clickable HTML prototype that the UI/UX Design Specification describes. The Release 1 prototype is the working Laravel application of the SDD on seed data with stub and Manual adapters (PRD Sections 5 and 7). D-22 and D-23 refer to the Release 1 prototype. Its acceptance script is the demonstration scenario of PRD Section 7; the walk-through flow FL-19 is rewritten to follow that scenario.	The same word was used for both, and FL-19 mixes three offerings (a Stand-alone Micro-Credential, an Unbundled one and a non-credit one) so it cannot test one record chain.	Proposed (v0.6)

ID	Decision	Rationale / effect if changed	Status
D-32	Release 1 is built in the four increments of PRD Section 5.3 (1.1 Foundation, 1.2 Curriculum, 1.3 Delivery and credentials, 1.4 Credit and quality). Build slices are planned inside these increments and do not reorder them.	Keeps one build order across the PRD and the SDD.	Proposed (v0.6)
D-33	DESIGN.md (Carbon with uLearn Navy) is accepted as the UTeM corporate identity for MCMS (SRS IR-08) until UTeM supplies its own guidelines.	The UI/UX Design Specification relies on this; v0.5 recorded no assumption for it.	Assumed (A-10)
D-34	The content of UCreds is taken from the UCreds Public Portal Audit v1.0 (27 October 2026; the folder `UCreds` of the project) and is recorded in Appendix A: the public catalogue (programmes, micro-courses, subjects with their codes, levels, durations and fees), the platform and the support services. The Release 1 prototype holds the catalogue as reference data (a screen for the CODL administrator, and course references offered on the offering form). The PRD Section 7 scenario keeps its own fictional micro-credentials. MCMS never copies UCreds content into an approved version: a UMC or SAMC is proposed and approved in MCMS, and a UCreds course is only referred to by its course reference.	The audit read only public pages; it is a working reference, not an agreement with CODL. Appendix A is replaced when CODL supplies the live catalogue.	Decided (v0.7)
D-35	The Release 1 prototype is judged against the requirements of the SRS, the PRD, the UI/UX Design Specification and the SDD. Its screens need not match the design prototype in layout or look, as long as every requirement, flow and document of those four documents is met. The navy side navigation and the DESIGN.md tokens stay (A-10).	Stated by the project owner on 28 October 2026. It ends a review of screen fidelity and keeps the effort on requirements.	Superseded by D-38 (v0.8)
D-36	For Release 1 a credential is signed as a VC-JOSE (JWT, EdDSA) proof of the Open Badges 3.0 credential, with the Ed25519 key of AD-09. The Data Integrity proof eddsa-rdfc-2022 stays the target. Public keys are published as a JWKS; a rotated key is retired, not deleted.	The spike found no PHP library that canonicalises a Verifiable Credentials v2 document (RDFC-1.0). This is the fallback that the SDD named.	Decided (v0.7)
D-37	A demo clock that moves the date forward is part of the Release 1 prototype (PRD 7.2). It exists only in a test environment: it needs the test sign-in and its own switch, and it is refused in production (SRS FR-05). The moved date lasts for one request and never moves the idle timeout.	Quality Verification and credit expiry cannot be shown otherwise.	Decided (v0.7)

ID	Decision	Rationale / effect if changed	Status
D-38	The Release 1 prototype follows the approved design prototype (UI/UX Design Specification v1.2, folder UIUX/v2/prototype) in style, arrangement, structure and content: shell, navigation, tables with sortable headers, search and paging, dialogs, toasts, menus and the screens of each role. Features the design prototype does not show but the SRS, PRD, UI/UX Design Specification or SDD require (for example a participant's results and feedback) are added in the same style, and are kept simple: the first view shows the summary and the next action, and detail opens on request (tab, drawer or detail page). The navy side navigation and the DESIGN.md tokens stay (A-10).	Stated by the project owner on 28 October 2026 after seeing the built screens. It replaces D-35.	Decided (v0.8)

3.3 Assumptions Register

ID	Assumption	Effect if wrong
A-01	Superseded in v0.5 by D-11 (deputy dean endorses, Senate approves, deputy dean records Senate decisions, degree-owning deputy dean decides transfers).	Approver bodies remain settings.
A-02	ABC and QVC/MQA accept submissions manually in Release 1.	A real adapter is added later.
A-03	UTeM's payment hub is not ready; a dummy payment service is used.	Replace one adapter.
A-04	UCreds is the pilot learning platform; its connection method is unknown.	CSV import is the fallback; connector design shifts.
A-05	UCreds already issues module badges and has its own database. The audit of 27 October 2026 supports this: UCreds runs on Moodle 3.17, grades and badges on its own.	MCMS issues badges itself if UCreds should not.
A-06	Outside applicants register at Pejabat Pendaftar or HEPA, then sign in with a Microsoft education account.	Add an applicant pre-registration screen.
A-07	Superseded in v0.5 by D-12 and D-29: CODL is administrator and technical operator only; credentials and ACR are produced by the system after deputy dean verification.	Role holders change in settings.
A-08	Retention periods are placeholders.	Edit settings.
A-09	Sizing is indicative: 200 offerings and 20,000 participants a year, peaks of 2,000 registering within hours.	Capacity plan changes.
A-10	DESIGN.md is the UTeM corporate identity for MCMS (D-33).	Colours, type and logo usage change in the style tokens only.

3.4 Open Items for CODL / Supervisor Confirmation

OI-01 to OI-08 were raised in v0.1. OI-09 to OI-15 were found while writing the SRS v1.0 draft and are added in v0.3; the SRS requirements they affect are listed in its Appendix C. Closed items keep their row and ID, with the decision that closed them.

ID	Question	Needed by	Working assumption until answered
OI-01	Which Guide version is controlling: V2.0 (15 Sep 2026) or V1.0 (18 Sep 2026)?	Closed (v0.4)	The copy held in the project, Versi 1.0, 18 Sep 2026 (D-03)

ID	Question	Needed by	Working assumption until answered
OI-02	Is a PostgreSQL server available, or must the system use MySQL/MariaDB?	Before staging set-up (SDD issued on the working assumption)	PostgreSQL, portable queries (D-09)
OI-03	Which SSO protocol and tenant settings does UTeM allow for the Microsoft education account? How are outside applicants recognised?	Before staging set-up (SDD issued on the working assumption)	OpenID Connect; account attribute or imported list (D-10)
OI-04	How does UCreds connect (web service, data export, Moodle link) and does it issue badges? Partly answered in v0.7: UCreds runs Moodle 3.17 and issues badges (Appendix A); the connection is still to be agreed.	Next iteration	CSV import; UCreds issues badges (D-13)
OI-05	Is a separately credit-bearing UMC module an approved case at UTeM, and who approves it?	Closed (v0.4)	Allowed by case-by-case academic approval; approving role is a setting (D-18)
OI-06	Which committee or role approves each decision (offering, transfer rules, stackable mapping, material change)?	Closed (v0.5)	Deputy dean endorses, Senate approves, deputy dean records; degree-owning deputy dean decides transfers (D-11)
OI-07	Retention periods for each record category.	Before go-live	Placeholder settings; ACR retained indefinitely [G 12.8]
OI-08	Who owns the credential signing keys and the public verification page?	Before go-live	CODL (D-12)
OI-09	What are the credit transfer limits and non-transferable components of each target programme, and who maintains them? [G 13.5]	Before Release 1 testing	Programme settings entered by the faculty; the system warns only
OI-10	How will MCMS learn of programme admission, completion and withdrawal, which drive the redemption status of credit? [G 12.9, 14.4]	Before SDD	Recorded manually by an authorised user from programme records
OI-11	What data and file format does ABC require for an ACR deposit, and how are redemption updates sent to ABC? [G 12.5, 18.6]	Before Release 1 testing	Export of the ACR fields of Appendix F3 in CSV and PDF
OI-12	What fee rules, refund rules and sponsorship arrangements apply to offerings?	Before Release 2	Fee set per offering; refunds handled outside MCMS
OI-13	What is the completion window for a modular UMC ("tempoh kesahan pembelajaran", G 7.4, 12.2)?	Before Release 1 testing	Default setting umc.completion_window_months (no value until answered), which an offering may override; no reminder is sent while no value is set
OI-14	Confirm that 40 notional learning hours equal 1 credit for UMC and SAMC calculations. [G 6.3.1]	Closed (v0.4)	Confirmed: 40 hours = 1 credit (D-27)
OI-15	Which identity verification methods are required for online assessment at each risk level? [G 10.4]	Before Release 1 testing	Recorded per assessment; method chosen by the PTj

4. Change Control

This document is the single place where terms and decisions change. A change shall state the decision ID, the new wording, the reason and the date, and shall raise the document version. The SRS, PRD and SDD shall cite the version of this document they were written against.

Version	Date	Change
0.1	23 October 2026	First issue: glossary, decisions D-01 to D-23, open items.
0.2	23 October 2026	Restyled to follow the reference document format; added Key Concepts, assumptions register, change history, decisions D-24 to D-26; D-04, D-05 and D-22 reworded.
0.3	23 October 2026	Added open items OI-09 to OI-15 raised while writing the SRS v1.0 draft. "Needed by" of OI-01 and OI-05 changed from "Before SRS" to "Before SRS approval", since the SRS draft now exists and uses their working assumptions. Added the SRS v1.0 draft to the references. The current assumptions (release scope, indicative performance figures) are accepted by the project owner for now. No decision changed.
0.4	26 October 2026	Closed OI-01 (D-03 now Decided: the project's copy of the Guide, Versi 1.0, 18 Sep 2026, controls), OI-05 (D-18 now Decided: module credit by case-by-case academic approval, approving role is a setting) and OI-14 (new D-27: 1 credit = 40 notional learning hours). D-23 changed: documents and the prototype proceed on recorded assumptions, with supervisor review once the prototype can be shown.
0.5	26 October 2026	User model simplified to Student, Lecturer, Deputy dean, Senate (no login), CODL (administrator and technical operator only) and public verifiers (new D-28). Credentials and ACR produced by the system after deputy dean verification (new D-29). D-11 now Decided: deputy dean endorses, Senate approves, deputy dean records Senate decisions, degree-owning deputy dean decides transfers (closes OI-06). D-12: CODL holds no academic role. D-14: ABC deposit stays in the flow and is recorded by the deputy dean; the national ABC platform is a concept only. D-18 names the deputy dean as approver. A-01 and A-07 superseded.
0.6	27 October 2026	Added D-30 (document set now includes the UI/UX Design Specification and the System Flow Map), D-31 (design prototype and Release 1 prototype defined; FL-19 to follow PRD Section 7), D-32 (Release 1 built in the PRD increments) and D-33 with A-10 (DESIGN.md as corporate identity). D-01 and D-23 updated. "Needed by" of OI-02, OI-03 and OI-08 changed because the SDD was issued on their working assumptions. OI-13 working assumption reconciled between SRS and SDD. Source: consistency review of 27 October 2026.
0.7	28 October 2026	Added Appendix A, the content of UCreds taken from the UCreds Public Portal Audit v1.0, and D-34 (UCreds content basis). Added D-35 (the Release 1 prototype is judged against the requirements, not against the look of the design prototype), D-36 (VC-JOSE credential proof for Release 1) and D-37 (demo clock, test environments only). D-13, A-05 and OI-04 updated with what the audit confirmed. UCreds glossary entry and references updated.
0.8	28 October 2026	Added D-38 (the Release 1 prototype follows the design prototype in style, arrangement, structure and content; additions for requirements are allowed and kept simple). D-35 marked superseded.

Appendix A: UCreds Content

This appendix records what the UCreds public portal contains and how it works, as found by the UCreds Public Portal Audit v1.0 of 27 October 2026 (D-34). The audit used only public pages. Where this appendix and the live portal differ, the live portal is right, and CODL's catalogue replaces this appendix when it is supplied.

A.1 The platform

Part	What the audit found	What it means for MCMS
Learning engine	Moodle 3.17 (build 20201109) with the Fordson theme; courses, quizzes, gradebooks, SCORM packages and enrolments live here	The source of results and badges; reached only through an adapter (D-06)
Catalogue	A custom catalogue in front of Moodle (jQuery and AJAX, `/catalog/action.php`) with search, categories and pages; a course page per Moodle course ID	A UCreds course is identified by its course ID, and by its subject code when it has one (for example MAXL5123)
Support site	WordPress 6.4.3 with a knowledge base of 36 articles under `/support/student/`	Outside MCMS; MCMS only links to it
Sign-in	Microsoft Entra ID (OpenID Connect) for staff and students with UTeM accounts; Google OAuth2 or Moodle accounts for outside learners	Outside learners exist on UCreds; MCMS recognises them as applicants (OI-03)
Network	A campus web application firewall that blocks unmodified automation (HTTP 500, Attack ID 20000051)	Tests of the UCreds screens need a real browser; the CSV exchange is not affected
Badges and records	Passing grade C (50%) gives a Digital Badge and a record of the module in the learner's own record	Supports A-05; MCMS imports the badge data and issues the certificate and Digital Credential after verification

A.2 What the catalogue contains

The audit states 60 public offerings: 3 ODL Master programmes, 2 structured learning paths and 55 specialised micro-courses, over an underlying Moodle repository of 214 course instances. Fees range from free to RM 150.00 for micro-courses, and up to RM 25,110.00 for a full programme.

Domain	Offerings	Typical duration	Fee range (MYR)	Audience
ODL Master degree programmes	3	1.5 to 2.0 years	22,610 to 25,110	Postgraduate scholars and executives
Structured learning paths	2	30 to 60 hours	Free to 150.00	Data engineers and AI practitioners
Mathematics and computational science	12	10 to 18 hours	12.00 to free	Engineering and computer science students
AI, machine learning and analytics	10	12 to 25 hours	12.00 to free	Industry analysts and software engineers
Cybersecurity and digital hygiene	5	8 to 15 hours	12.00 to free	Corporate employees and public learners
Database systems and big data	4	10 to 18 hours	12.00 to free	Database administrators and developers

Domain	Offerings	Typical duration	Fee range (MYR)	Audience
Programming languages and development	8	10 to 30 hours	12.00 to free	Novice programmers and mobile developers
TVET, robotics and engineering	7	8 to 20 hours	12.00 to free	TVET educators and mechanical engineers
Languages, soft skills and humanities	7	8 to 15 hours	12.00 to free	Working professionals and the general public
Academic research and methodology	2	10 to 15 hours	Free	Postgraduate and final year researchers

A.3 Programmes, subjects and subject codes

Three programmes are delivered by Open and Distance Learning. The audit profiles two of them. A subject is a course of 120 hours, which is 3 credits at 40 hours a credit (D-27). Subject codes begin with the programme prefix (MAXL for the data science programme, MPSW for the shared research course).

Programme	Faculty	Duration and fee	Subjects (core curriculum)
Master of Technology in Data Science and Analytics (MTDL), course ID 80, MQA/PA17473	FTMK	1.5 to 3 years, 100% online; MYR 25,110.00	MAXL5113 Fundamentals of Data Science; MAXL5123 Big Data Management; MAXL5133 Applied Statistical Methods; MAXL5143 Applied Machine Learning; MAXL5153 Big Data Analytics and Visualization; MAXL5163 Modelling and Decision Making; MPSW5013 Research Methodology; MAXL5223 Group Project
Master of Business Administration (MBA), course ID 78	FPTT	1.5 years in trimesters, 100% online; MYR 22,610.00	Strategic Management, Managerial Economics, Technopreneurship, Corporate Finance, Human Capital Analytics, and a Business Research Dissertation (pillars; the audit lists no subject codes)
Master of Electronic Engineering (Computer Engineering), course ID 1560	FKE	1600 hours; no fee shown	Not profiled in the audit

The audit shows the stackable route of the data science programme in four tiers: standalone micro-courses of 10 to 20 hours (for example MAXL5123 Big Data Management Demystified, Document and Graph Databases, Hadoop Core Technologies, Spark Data Analysis), a subject of 120 hours and 3 credits (MAXL5123 Big Data Management), the core curriculum of 40 to 42 credits, and the accredited award. In MCMS this is the pathway of MD-13: a mapping transfers no credit, and each credit still goes through credit transfer evaluation (MD-12).

A.4 The public course directory

The tables below are the directory of the audit, without the author column. Each row has the Moodle course ID, the title (a subject code may be part of the title), the level, the student learning time and the fee. A row with no duration or fee is free or has no fixed duration. The audit's tables list 59 rows in all (3 programmes and 56 courses), while its summary says 60 offerings, 2 learning paths and 55 micro-courses. The audit lists no learning path, so the difference is for CODL to reconcile. MCMS does not depend on the exact count.

ODL Master Degree Programmes (3 listed)

ID	Programme Title	Level	Duration	Total Fee
78	Master of Business Administration	Master	1600 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 22,610.00
80	Master of Technology in Data Science and Analytics	Master	1600 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 25,110.00
1560	Master of Electronic Engineering (Computer Engineering)	Master	1600 Hours 00 Minutes	-

Mathematics, Calculus & Computational Methods (13 listed)

ID	Course Title	Level	Duration	Fee
155	First Order Differential Equations	Intermediate	18 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 12.00
140	Second Order Linear Differential Equations	Intermediate	18 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 12.00
138	Laplace Transform	Intermediate	33 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 12.00
157	Fourier Series	Intermediate	18 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 10.00
154	Partial Differential Equations	Intermediate	33 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 12.00
1430	Math is Fun Aras 1: Penambahan dan Penolakan (Lingkungan 0-100, Tahun 1)	Beginner	-	Free
1431	Math is Fun Aras 2: Penambahan dan Penolakan (Lingkungan 1000, Tahun 2)	Beginner	-	Free
1432	Math is Fun Aras 3: Penambahan, Penolakan, Darab, dan Bahagi (Lingkungan 10,000, Tahun 3)	Beginner	-	Free
1433	Math is Fun Aras 4: Operasi Aritmetik Lanjutan (Lingkungan 100,000, Tahun 4)	Beginner	-	Free
1434	Math is Fun Aras 5: Operasi Aritmetik Kompleks (Lingkungan 1,000,000, Tahun 5)	Beginner	-	Free
1435	Math is Fun Aras 6: Penguatan Operasi Aritmetik (Lingkungan 10,000,000, Tahun 6)	Beginner	-	Free
661	Application of Graph Theory: Network Modelling	Intermediate	11 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 29.90
1425	MATH is FUN Juara Asas Pengiraan	Beginner	-	Free

Artificial Intelligence, Data Science & Machine Learning (10 listed)

ID	Course Title	Level	Duration	Fee
515	Embracing Machine Learning for Business Decision [PM Choo]	Beginner	06 Hours 30 Minutes	MYR 50.00
517	7. [MAXL5143] Introduction to Deep Learning	Intermediate	07 Hours 30 Minutes	Free
530	6.[MAXL5113] Overview of Analytics Models	Beginner	06 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 50.00
435	Data Modeling	Beginner	16 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 84.00

ID	Course Title	Level	Duration	Fee
262	Artificial Intelligence for Everyone	Beginner	08 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 10.00
519	Time Series Forecasting	Intermediate	08 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 150.00
665	Kick-start Your Ambition as Machine Learning Engineer	Beginner	08 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 9.99
817	Working with Machine Learning by Examples	Intermediate	15 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 19.99
1296	MAXL5273 Customer and Financial Analytics [Elective]	Intermediate	120 Hours 00 Minutes	Free
648	Journey Towards Artificial Intelligence	Beginner	10 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 10.00

Cybersecurity, Information Security & Privacy (5 listed)

ID	Course Title	Level	Duration	Fee
486	Phishing Techniques	Beginner	04 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 9.99
436	Social Engineering	Beginner	04 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 9.99
487	Security at home	Beginner	04 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 9.99
489	Password and Authentication 101	Beginner	04 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 9.99
543	Public Wi-Fi Security	Beginner	04 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 9.99

Database Engineering & Big Data Management (3 listed)

ID	Course Title	Level	Duration	Fee
520	1. [MAXL5123] Big Data Management Demystified	Intermediate	07 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 50.00
644	Fundamentals of a Database	Beginner	16 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 84.00
512	Maximize Your Database Efficiency: A Normalization Practical Guide	Beginner	16 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 80.00

Software Engineering, Programming & Mobile Apps (7 listed)

ID	Course Title	Level	Duration	Fee
1883	Python Essentials 1: Module 3	Beginner	-	Free
2009	Python Essentials 1: Module 4	Beginner	-	Free
290	Java Programming for Beginners	Beginner	04 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 50.00
571	Easy-Peasy Python Programming	Beginner	08 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 20.00
827	Membina Aplikasi Flutter: Panduan Praktikal	Beginner	25 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 150.00

ID	Course Title	Level	Duration	Fee
1541	PlaCe-GMC: Player-Based JavaScript Journey	Beginner	08 Hours 00 Minutes	Free
1881	Level 1: Hello, World! — Basics of Python Programming	Beginner	120 Hours 00 Minutes	Free

Advanced TVET, Robotics & Mechanical Engineering (10 listed)

ID	Course Title	Level	Duration	Fee
132	Industrial Robotics for Industry 4.0	Beginner	08 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 5.00
309	3D Design using AUTODESK INVENTOR as easy 1 2 3	Beginner	01 Hours 25 Minutes	MYR 10.00
498	Getting Started with STM32 IoT	Beginner	06 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 19.00
499	Buoyancy: Float the body, or sink it?	Beginner	08 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 2.00
568	Control Chart for Beginners in TVET Education	Beginner	08 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 39.90
573	Mudahnya Robot Mudah Alih!	Beginner	08 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 15.00
580	CAD Modeling: Easy Modeling Vertebrae Bone using MRI Images	Intermediate	08 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 10.00
659	3D Scanning to 3D Printing	Beginner	08 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 20.00
808	Visualise Product Through Packaging	Beginner	08 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 10.00
809	Teknologi dan Kejuruteraan Sistem Kawalan dalam Kehidupan	Beginner	08 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 20.00

Languages, Communication & Soft Skills (8 listed)

ID	Course Title	Level	Duration	Fee
412	The Essentials of Critical and Creative Thinking for Innovation	Beginner	04 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 4.99
182	Speak Mandarin Using Chinese Phonetics	Beginner	12 Hours 00 Minutes	Free
184	The Wonders of Chinese Characters	Beginner	12 Hours 00 Minutes	Free
553	Berani Berucap	Beginner	42 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 39.00
570	Beautiful Photo with Smartphone Photography Techniques	Beginner	04 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 10.00
1776	MPU21072 Pengenalan Penghayatan Etika dan Peradaban Dalam Acuan Malaysia	Beginner	120 Hours 00 Minutes	Free
1513	Writing Literature Review	Beginner	07 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 100.00
1770	Literature Search (FTMK)	Beginner	06 Hours 00 Minutes	MYR 100.00

A.5 Course profiles

The audit profiles seven courses in depth, each with the prerequisites, the syllabus and the learning outcomes. They are the best examples of what a UMC or SAMC proposal in MCMS would be built from.

Course ID	Course	Level and learning time	Fee	Prerequisites
155	First Order Differential Equations (mathematics series)	Intermediate; 18 hours	MYR 12.00	Basic single-variable differential and integral calculus
517	Introduction to Deep Learning (MAXL5143)	Intermediate; 15 hours	MYR 12.00	Foundations of Python programming and linear algebra
644	Fundamentals of a Database	Beginner; 12 hours	MYR 12.00	None
573	Mudahnya Robot Mudah Alih! (mobile robotics)	Beginner, TVET; 10 hours	MYR 12.00	Basic interest in electronics and microcontroller logic
486	Phishing Techniques and Cyber Hygiene	Beginner; 8 hours	MYR 12.00	None (general public)
80 and 78	The two ODL Master programmes of A.3	Master; 1600 hours	See A.3	A bachelor's degree with a minimum CGPA of 2.50, or relevant experience, or APEL.A

The figures above are those of the profiles. The audit's directory (A.4) gives other figures for the same courses: 517 is 7 hours 30 minutes and free; 644 is 16 hours and MYR 84.00; 573 is 8 hours and MYR 15.00; 486 is 4 hours and MYR 9.99. The audit does not say which is current, so the live course page decides, and the difference is one more item for CODL to reconcile.

A.6 Learner support

Service	What it offers
Helpdesk	Email ucreds.helpdesk@utem.edu.my (reply within 24 operational hours; screenshots needed for errors); telephone 06-229 2272; 8:00 to 17:00 Monday to Friday (Malaysia time); a virtual companion that answers navigation, sign-in and enrolment questions
Knowledge base (36 articles)	eOrientation and regulations (14 articles: ODL handbook, postgraduate regulations, exam portal, fee schedule, course registration); eCounselling and wellness (19 articles); online campus facilities (3 articles: virtual library, campus VPN, student welfare)
Regulations the articles state	The UTeM postgraduate grading scheme, where grade B (CGPA 3.00) is the lowest pass for credit towards a degree; authenticated access to the digital library (IEEE Xplore, ScienceDirect, Scopus) through EZproxy and VPN

Source: UCreds Public Portal Audit v1.0 (UCREDS_AUDIT_V1.0_Oct_2026), Sections 2 to 6. The audit's own claim that UCreds meets the single redemption principle and the stackable pathway is a statement about UCreds' content; in MCMS those rules are enforced by MD-11, MD-12 and MD-13.